

HR & Candidate Conversations

Interview scheduling and follow-up - realistic spoken English practice

A polished set of fourteen realistic phone and video-call conversations for interview preparation. It includes 215 spoken dialogue turns with natural professional language, clear context, and practical follow-up questions. The candidate profile reflects a Senior Java Developer with experience in Java, Spring Boot, Hibernate JPA, microservices, REST APIs, and JWT security.

How to practise

Read each role aloud. Then repeat the conversation without looking, adapting the details to your own experience and availability.

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1. Initial screening call - agreeing a first interview

The recruiter confirms fit for the role and agrees a mutually convenient interview time.

HR	Hello, may I speak with Manoj Kumar Panda, please?
Manoj	Speaking. Hello - may I know who is calling?
HR	Hi Manoj. This is Anjali from Bright Software Solutions. I am calling about your application for the Senior Java Developer role. Is now a convenient time for a brief conversation?
Manoj	Yes, absolutely. Thank you for calling.
HR	I have reviewed your profile. Your experience with Java, Spring Boot, REST APIs, and microservices at HTC Global Services seems closely aligned with what our team needs.
Manoj	Thank you. In my current role, I work mainly on backend services, including API development, data persistence with Hibernate JPA, and service-to-service integration.
HR	I also noticed your work on the EBOOKERS travel booking platform. Could you briefly tell me what part of that project you owned?
Manoj	Certainly. I contributed to booking and user-management services, and I worked on payment-related APIs. I was also involved in securing endpoints using JWT-based authentication.
HR	That is helpful context. We would like to invite you to an initial technical discussion. Would you be interested in proceeding?
Manoj	Yes, I would be very interested. Please let me know the available slots.
HR	We have Thursday at 11:00 a.m. or Thursday at 2:00 p.m. Which would suit you better?
Manoj	Could we please schedule it for 2:00 p.m.? I have a morning commitment at work, but I can be fully available in the afternoon.
HR	Of course. I will reserve Thursday at 2:00 p.m. and send a calendar invitation shortly. Please review it once you receive it.
Manoj	Thank you, Anjali. I will check the invite and confirm my attendance today.
HR	I will also include the role description and the names of the interviewers in the invitation, so you know what to expect.
Manoj	That would be very helpful. I will review the description again and prepare examples that are relevant to the role.
HR	Excellent. If a conflict arises before Thursday, please let us know as early as possible so we can help.

Language focus

Useful phrase: 'Could we please schedule it for ...?' It is polite, clear, and gives a brief professional reason.

2. Follow-up call - confirming the interview slot

The recruiter verifies the appointment and resolves small practical details before the interview.

HR	Hello Manoj, this is Anjali from Bright Software Solutions. I am calling to confirm your interview scheduled for Thursday.
Manoj	Hello, Anjali. Yes, thank you for calling. I have the interview marked in my calendar.
HR	Wonderful. It is scheduled for Thursday at 2:00 p.m. and should take about forty-five minutes. Does that timing still work for you?
Manoj	Yes, it does. I will be available and can join a few minutes early.
HR	I sent the meeting invitation yesterday. Were you able to access the link and the role description?
Manoj	Yes, I received both. The link opens correctly, and I have read through the job description.
HR	Excellent. The panel may ask about your recent Spring Boot work, so an updated resume would be useful if anything has changed since you applied.
Manoj	My experience and contact details are unchanged, but I can reply to your email with the latest PDF copy for completeness.
HR	That would be appreciated. Please also keep a government-issued ID nearby in case the interviewer needs a quick identity check.
Manoj	Certainly. I will have it ready.
HR	Do you have any questions about the format before we end the call?
Manoj	Just one. Will it be a video call with one interviewer or a panel?
HR	It will be a video call with a technical lead and a senior engineer. They will introduce themselves at the start.
Manoj	That is clear. Thank you for the information. I look forward to speaking with them on Thursday.
HR	The invitation will show Indian Standard Time. Please check that the time zone has not changed in your calendar settings.
Manoj	I have checked it, and it correctly shows Thursday at 2:00 p.m. IST.
HR	Great. A prompt reply to the invitation will complete the confirmation from your side.

Language focus

Useful phrase: 'For completeness, I can send the latest copy.' This sounds cooperative without implying that something is missing.

3. Candidate requests to reschedule

The candidate gives timely notice, offers alternatives, and keeps the tone respectful.

Manoj	Hello, this is Manoj Panda. May I speak with Anjali from the recruitment team, please?
HR	Speaking, Manoj. How can I help?
Manoj	I am calling about my interview scheduled for Thursday at 2:00 p.m. I am sorry for the short notice, but an urgent production issue has come up in my current project.
HR	I understand. Thank you for letting us know before the interview. Would you like to reschedule?
Manoj	Yes, if possible. I remain very interested in the opportunity, and I would prefer a time when I can give the discussion my full attention.
HR	That makes sense. Do you have a preferred day next week?
Manoj	Monday or Tuesday afternoon would work well for me. I can be flexible between 1:00 and 4:00 p.m.
HR	Let me check the panel's calendar. Monday at 2:00 p.m. is currently available. Would that suit you?
Manoj	Yes, Monday at 2:00 p.m. would be perfect. Thank you for accommodating the change.
HR	No problem. I will cancel the existing invitation and send a new one. Please accept the updated invite when it arrives.
Manoj	I will do that immediately. Again, I apologize for the inconvenience.
HR	There is no need to worry. We appreciate the advance notice. I will speak with you on Monday.
Manoj	Thank you, Anjali. Have a good day.
HR	Would you like me to note that the change is due to an urgent production responsibility?
Manoj	Yes, please. I want the panel to know that I value their time and that this is an exceptional situation.
HR	I will add a brief note and confirm the new appointment by email.

Language focus

Useful phrase: 'I would prefer a time when I can give the discussion my full attention.' It explains a rescheduling request positively.

4. HR offers an alternate slot

The recruiter changes the schedule professionally and reassures the candidate.

HR	Hello Manoj, this is Anjali from Bright Software Solutions. I am calling about Monday's interview.
Manoj	Hello, Anjali. Yes, I am ready to discuss it.
HR	I am afraid the technical lead has been pulled into an urgent client meeting, so we need to move your interview. I apologize for the inconvenience.
Manoj	Thank you for informing me. I understand that unexpected commitments can arise. What alternatives do you have?
HR	We can offer Tuesday at 11:00 a.m., Tuesday at 3:00 p.m., or Wednesday at 11:00 a.m.
Manoj	Tuesday at 3:00 p.m. would be the most convenient option for me. Would the interview format remain the same?
HR	Yes. It will still be a forty-five-minute Google Meet discussion with the technical lead and senior engineer.
Manoj	That works well. I will keep Tuesday at 3:00 p.m. free.
HR	Thank you for being flexible. I will send an updated invitation within the next fifteen minutes.
Manoj	I will watch for it and accept it as soon as I receive it.
HR	Please disregard the earlier calendar invite once the replacement arrives.
Manoj	Understood. Thank you for the clear update.
HR	If Tuesday becomes difficult for any reason, Wednesday morning is still being held as a backup for the moment.
Manoj	Thank you. Tuesday at 3:00 p.m. is confirmed from my side, so I do not expect to need the backup.
HR	Perfect. We will proceed with Tuesday and release the other option.

Language focus

Useful phrase: 'What alternatives do you have?' It is direct and professional when an employer changes the schedule.

5. Sharing interview details and required documents

The candidate checks practical requirements without sounding uncertain or unprepared.

HR	Hi Manoj. I am sending the final details for your interview on Tuesday at 3:00 p.m.
Manoj	Thank you. I have received the invitation. Could you please let me know whether there are any documents I should prepare?
HR	For the interview itself, please keep an updated resume and a government-issued photo ID available. If you proceed to the next stage, we may request academic and employment documents separately.
Manoj	Understood. I will have my resume and ID ready. Should I also keep digital copies of my B.Tech certificate and recent salary slips available?
HR	That would be sensible, although you do not need to send them now. Please share only what we request through an official company email.
Manoj	Thank you for clarifying. Since this is an online interview, do I need to install any software?
HR	No installation is required. Google Meet will open in your browser, but please test your microphone, camera, and internet connection in advance.
Manoj	I will do a quick test this evening. Is there a preferred time to join the meeting?
HR	Please join five minutes early. That gives us time to resolve any connection issue before the panel starts.
Manoj	Certainly. I will join at 2:55 p.m. and wait in the meeting room.
HR	Perfect. Please use a quiet place with a neutral background if possible.
Manoj	I have arranged a quiet room and will make sure there are no interruptions. Thank you for the guidance.
HR	For your security, please do not send bank information, PAN details, or passwords during the interview process.
Manoj	Thank you for mentioning that. I will share documents only through the official process you described.
HR	That is exactly right. We want candidates to feel comfortable and informed throughout the process.

Language focus

Useful phrase: 'Could you please let me know whether ...?' It is a polished way to ask for preparation details.

6. Reminder call - one day before the interview

The recruiter confirms attendance and helps the candidate understand what to expect.

HR	Hello Manoj. This is a quick reminder about your interview tomorrow at 3:00 p.m.
Manoj	Hello, Anjali. Thank you for the reminder. Yes, I will be available tomorrow.
HR	Great. I wanted to make sure the meeting link is working and that you have not had any changes in availability.
Manoj	The link works, and my schedule is unchanged. I plan to join about five minutes early.
HR	Excellent. There will be two interviewers: a technical lead and a project manager. The discussion will focus on your recent backend work rather than on puzzles alone.
Manoj	That is useful to know. May I ask whether they are particularly interested in my EBOOKERS project or in general Java concepts?
HR	Both. Please be ready to explain a service you designed, a technical challenge you faced, and how you collaborated with other teams.
Manoj	I will prepare examples around booking workflows, API security, and coordination with the QA team.
HR	That sounds appropriate. Please keep your explanations structured: situation, action, and result.
Manoj	I will. Thank you for the suggestion.
HR	Do you have any final logistical questions?
Manoj	No, everything is clear now. I appreciate your help and look forward to the discussion.
HR	Please avoid sharing confidential code or internal documents from your current employer during the interview.
Manoj	Of course. I will explain my work at a high level and use anonymized examples where necessary.
HR	That is the professional approach. The panel will respect those boundaries.

Language focus	Useful phrase: 'May I ask whether they are particularly interested in ...?' It makes a focused, relevant question sound courteous.
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7. Scheduling the technical round

After a successful screening, the recruiter sets expectations for a deeper technical conversation.

HR	Hello Manoj. I am pleased to let you know that you have cleared the initial discussion.
Manoj	That is very good news. Thank you for letting me know.
HR	The panel appreciated the way you explained your project responsibilities. We would like to schedule a technical round with our team lead.
Manoj	I would be happy to attend. When are you looking to schedule it?
HR	We have availability on Friday at 3:00 p.m. The session may last up to an hour. Would you be able to join then?
Manoj	Yes, Friday at 3:00 p.m. is convenient for me.
HR	This round will go deeper into core Java, Spring Boot, database design, REST APIs, microservices, and authentication. There may also be a short problem-solving exercise.
Manoj	Thank you for outlining the topics. Should I expect live coding, or will it be mainly a design discussion?
HR	It will be primarily conversational, with perhaps a small coding or debugging question. The lead is more interested in your reasoning than in a perfect answer.
Manoj	That is helpful. I will review my project decisions and be prepared to explain the trade-offs I made.
HR	Exactly. Please also be ready to discuss performance, error handling, and how your services communicate with one another.
Manoj	Certainly. I look forward to the round.
HR	You do not need to memorize definitions. The lead is interested in how you apply concepts in real projects.
Manoj	That suits my working style. I will focus on clear examples and explain why I selected particular approaches.
HR	Very good. Practical reasoning will make your answers stronger.

Language focus	Useful phrase: 'I will be prepared to explain the trade-offs I made.' This shows maturity and technical judgment.
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8. Scheduling the final HR round

The candidate learns what the final HR conversation covers and prepares factually.

HR	Hello Manoj. I hope you are well. I have positive feedback from the technical team.
Manoj	I am glad to hear that. Thank you for the update.
HR	They would like to move you to the final HR discussion. Are you available next Monday at 11:00 a.m.?
Manoj	Yes, I am available at that time. May I ask what the conversation will cover?
HR	We will discuss your career goals, current responsibilities, notice period, compensation expectations, and any questions you have about the company or role.
Manoj	Understood. I will keep the relevant details ready. Will this be the final stage before a decision?
HR	Yes, assuming there are no additional clarifications from the hiring manager, this is the final scheduled round.
Manoj	Thank you for clarifying. I will be prepared and will join on time.
HR	Please be open about your timelines and expectations. Clear information helps us move quickly if the outcome is positive.
Manoj	Absolutely. I will be transparent about my current notice period and any commitments I need to consider.
HR	Very good. I will send a calendar invitation for Monday at 11:00 a.m.
Manoj	Thank you, Anjali. I look forward to speaking with you then.
HR	There is no paperwork to complete before this round. Just join from a quiet place and keep the time free.
Manoj	Understood. I will make sure I am not interrupted and will keep the entire hour available.
HR	Thank you. That will help the conversation run smoothly.

Language focus

Useful phrase: 'May I ask what the conversation will cover?' It helps you prepare without sounding demanding.

9. Interview day - confirming readiness

A brief check-in addresses technical setup and gives the candidate calm, practical guidance.

HR	Good morning, Manoj. This is Anjali from Bright Software Solutions. I am just checking in before your interview this afternoon.
Manoj	Good morning, Anjali. Thank you for calling. I am all set for the 2:00 p.m. interview.
HR	Wonderful. Have you been able to test your internet connection, camera, and microphone?
Manoj	Yes. I tested everything this morning, and the meeting link opens correctly.
HR	Perfect. Please join by 1:55 p.m. If you face a connection issue, reply to the calendar invitation or call the recruitment number in the email.
Manoj	Understood. I have noted both options.
HR	The panel may ask you to share your screen for a diagram or a small coding question. Are you comfortable doing that?
Manoj	Yes. I have closed personal windows and prepared a clean workspace in case screen sharing is needed.
HR	That is ideal. Keep a notebook nearby, but try not to read directly from prepared notes during the discussion.
Manoj	Of course. I will use notes only to remember questions or key points.
HR	Excellent. Take a moment before you join, speak at a steady pace, and ask for clarification if a question is unclear.
Manoj	Thank you. That is reassuring. I appreciate your support.
HR	If you are running even a few minutes late, please send a message immediately rather than waiting until the meeting starts.
Manoj	Certainly. I have planned to be ready early, but I will notify you straight away if anything unexpected happens.
HR	Thank you. Clear communication is always appreciated.

Language focus

Useful phrase: 'Could you please repeat or rephrase the question?' Asking for clarification is better than guessing.

10. Post-interview follow-up

The recruiter acknowledges the interview, shares a realistic timeline, and avoids making premature promises.

HR	Hello Manoj. Thank you for taking the time to speak with our panel today.
Manoj	Thank you for arranging the interview. I enjoyed learning more about the team and the role.
HR	I am pleased to hear that. How did you find the discussion?
Manoj	It was a good conversation. I was especially interested in the questions about API design and scaling booking-related services.
HR	The panel noted that you explained your JWT authentication work clearly and gave practical examples from EBOOKERS.
Manoj	That is encouraging. Please let me know if they need any additional information from my side.
HR	At the moment, no further action is needed. The panel will complete their feedback, and we expect to update you within two to three working days.
Manoj	Thank you. I appreciate having a clear timeline.
HR	If the process takes longer than expected, I will let you know rather than leaving you without an update.
Manoj	I appreciate that. I will wait to hear from you.
HR	Thank you again for your time and preparation.
Manoj	Thank you, Anjali. Have a good day.
HR	You do not need to send a separate follow-up email today unless you have a specific question or document to share.
Manoj	That is helpful. I will wait for the update, and I will respond promptly if you contact me.
HR	Perfect. We will be in touch as soon as the feedback is finalized.

Language focus

Useful phrase: 'Please let me know if they need any additional information from my side.' It is proactive but not pushy.

11. Scheduling the managerial round

The candidate prepares for leadership, teamwork, and delivery questions, not only technical questions.

HR	Hello Manoj. I have good news: the technical panel has recommended you for a conversation with our engineering manager.
Manoj	That is wonderful news. Thank you very much.
HR	The manager is available tomorrow at 4:00 p.m. Would you be able to attend a video call at that time?
Manoj	Yes, 4:00 p.m. tomorrow works for me.
HR	Great. This round is less about detailed coding and more about how you work with people, handle priorities, and take ownership.
Manoj	Thank you for explaining that. Should I prepare examples from my current project?
HR	Yes, please prepare two or three examples: one involving cross-functional collaboration, one involving a delivery challenge, and one showing how you handled feedback or disagreement.
Manoj	I can discuss how I coordinated with QA and frontend teams during a booking flow release, as well as an issue we resolved under a tight timeline.
HR	Those examples sound relevant. The manager may also ask about Agile ceremonies and how you balance quality with delivery speed.
Manoj	Understood. I will prepare concise examples with the context, my contribution, and the result.
HR	Excellent. I will send the Google Meet invitation shortly.
Manoj	Thank you. I look forward to speaking with the engineering manager.
HR	The manager is especially interested in how you make decisions when requirements are incomplete or priorities change.
Manoj	I can prepare an example where I clarified requirements with stakeholders before committing the team to an implementation.
HR	That would be a strong example. Please include how you communicated the decision and its outcome.

Language focus	Useful phrase: 'I will prepare concise examples with the context, my contribution, and the result.' This signals structured communication.
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12. Offer discussion and joining date

The candidate responds warmly while asking for written details and discussing availability honestly.

HR	Hello Manoj. I am delighted to let you know that we would like to offer you the Senior Java Developer position.
Manoj	Thank you very much. I am genuinely pleased to hear that and grateful for the opportunity.
HR	The team was impressed by your technical background and the way you approached the interviews. I would like to discuss a possible joining date and the next steps.
Manoj	Certainly. I would be happy to discuss that.
HR	Could you confirm your current notice period at HTC Global Services?
Manoj	My formal notice period is thirty days. I will follow the proper handover process, although I can check whether an earlier release is possible after I receive the written offer.
HR	That is reasonable. Based on that timeline, would joining in about four weeks be realistic?
Manoj	Yes, that should be realistic. I can confirm an exact date once I discuss the transition plan with my current manager.
HR	Perfect. We will send the formal offer letter by email today, including compensation, benefits, reporting manager, and onboarding documents.
Manoj	Thank you. I will read the offer carefully and respond within the stated timeline.
HR	Please feel free to send any questions in writing after you review it.
Manoj	I appreciate that. I am excited about the role and look forward to reviewing the details.
HR	The offer letter will specify the date by which we need your written acceptance. Please review that deadline carefully.
Manoj	I will. If I need clarification on any point, I will ask before the deadline rather than making assumptions.
HR	Excellent. We want you to make a well-informed decision.

Language focus	Useful phrase: 'I can confirm an exact date once I discuss the transition plan with my current manager.' It is accurate and avoids overpromising.
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13. Salary negotiation

The candidate expresses an expectation with evidence, stays respectful, and leaves room for discussion.

HR	Hello Manoj. Before we finalize the offer, I would like to discuss compensation with you.
Manoj	Certainly, Anjali. Thank you for arranging the discussion.
HR	Based on the role, your experience, and our internal range, we are prepared to offer a total annual package of twelve lakh rupees.
Manoj	Thank you for sharing the offer. I appreciate the opportunity and the confidence the team has shown in me.
HR	You are welcome. Do you have any questions or concerns about the package?
Manoj	After considering the responsibilities of the role and my experience designing Spring Boot microservices, securing APIs with JWT, and supporting the EBOOKERS platform, I was hoping for something closer to fourteen lakh rupees.
HR	I understand. Could you tell me whether that expectation is based on a particular offer or on your understanding of the market?
Manoj	It is based on the scope of the role, my current experience, and the value I believe I can contribute. I am open to a constructive discussion and would be happy to understand the full compensation structure as well.
HR	That is a fair explanation. I will speak with the hiring manager and our compensation team to see whether there is flexibility.
Manoj	Thank you. I appreciate you considering my request. I remain very interested in joining the team.
HR	I should have an update for you within two working days.
Manoj	That works for me. Thank you again for the transparent conversation.
HR	You do not need to decide during this call. We want you to have time to review the full offer and benefits.
Manoj	I appreciate that. A written breakdown will help me consider the opportunity carefully and respond responsibly.
HR	That is completely reasonable. I will return with a clear update after the review.

Language focus

Useful phrase: 'I was hoping for something closer to ...' It is firmer and more diplomatic than demanding a number.

14. Background verification

The candidate understands the process, shares documents safely, and asks about the timeline.

HR	Hello Manoj. This is Anjali from Bright Software Solutions. I am calling to explain the background-verification process.
Manoj	Hello, Anjali. Thank you. Please let me know what you need from me.
HR	We will verify your education and employment history after you accept the offer. You will receive a secure link from our verification partner rather than a request to send sensitive documents by chat.
Manoj	Thank you for clarifying the process. Which documents should I keep ready?
HR	Please keep your B.Tech certificate, identification document, recent address proof if applicable, and employment documents from HTC Global Services. The portal will show the exact list.
Manoj	Understood. I have digital copies of those documents and can upload them once I receive the secure link.
HR	We may also ask for the contact details of an HR representative or previous manager who can verify your employment dates.
Manoj	I can provide the appropriate official contact details. Should I inform the reference in advance?
HR	Yes, that is a good idea. Please tell them that they may receive a standard verification request and that they should respond through their official email address.
Manoj	I will do that. How long does the process usually take?
HR	It normally takes five to seven working days, depending on how quickly the institutions and employers respond. We will keep you updated if anything needs clarification.
Manoj	Thank you. I will complete the upload promptly once the link arrives.
HR	Please do not upload documents through an unverified link or share passwords with anyone claiming to be from the verification team.
Manoj	Understood. I will check that the email and portal are official before uploading any personal documents.
HR	Excellent. If anything looks unusual, contact me before taking action.

Language focus	Useful phrase: 'Could you please confirm the secure method for sharing these documents?' It protects your privacy and sounds professional.
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